Montgomery MyEnergy

Your Complete Roadmap to Lower Energy Bills

$605+
Tenant savings/year

$2,330+
Landlord savings/year

30%
Federal tax credit

51%
Bill goes to cooling

For Tenants — 6 Steps

1 Understand Your Energy Bill

Review your monthly energy bill to understand where your money goes. In Montgomery, a typical household pays $180–$260/month, with cooling (AC) accounting for 51% of the total bill.

✓ Check your bill for unusual spikes month-over-month

✓ Identify your rate plan — Flat (FD) vs Time-of-Use (RT)

✓ Note your average kWh usage to set a baseline

💰 **Knowing your baseline is the foundation for all savings**

2 Adjust Your Thermostat Settings

Set your thermostat to 68°F in winter and 78°F in summer. Each degree adjustment saves about 3% on your bill. With 5+ months of heavy AC use in Montgomery, this adds up fast.

✓ Set to 78°F when home, 85°F when away in summer

✓ Set to 68°F when home, 62°F when sleeping in winter

✓ Use blankets and fans to stay comfortable at these settings

💰 **Up to $200/year**

3 Eliminate Phantom Energy Loads

Phone chargers, game consoles, and TVs draw power even when turned off. These 'vampire' devices can account for up to 10% of your electricity bill.

✓ Use smart power strips to cut phantom loads automatically

✓ Unplug chargers, gaming consoles, and small appliances when not in use

✓ Identify which devices have standby LEDs — they're always drawing power

💰 **Up to $100/year**

4 Optimize Lighting & Appliance Use

Lighting and appliances account for 18% of your bill. Leverage natural daylight and shift heavy-use appliances to off-peak hours (after 9 PM) for lower rates.

✓ Open blinds during the day to reduce lighting needs

✓ Use blackout curtains on south-facing windows to block summer heat

✓ Run dishwashers, dryers, and heavy appliances during off-peak hours

💰 **Up to $195/year**

5 Use Ceiling Fans & Cold Water

Run ceiling fans counterclockwise in summer for a cooling breeze, clockwise in winter to push warm air down. Wash clothes in cold water — 90% of washing machine energy goes to heating water.

✓ Reverse fan direction seasonally for optimal airflow

✓ Always turn fans off when leaving the room

✓ Switch to cold-water wash cycles with modern detergent

💰 **Up to $110/year**

6 Ask Your Landlord About Upgrades

Under the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA), landlords can receive tax credits of up to 30% on qualifying energy-efficiency improvements. These savings can be passed through to you in lower bills.

✓ Request smart thermostat installation (fastest ROI for landlords)

✓ Ask about weatherstripping and air sealing for your unit

✓ Inquire about LED lighting retrofits for common areas

💰 **Indirect savings from landlord upgrades: $300–$600/year**

For Landlords — 7 Steps

1 Get a Professional Energy Audit

Montgomery offers free or subsidized energy audits. Identify the biggest energy wasters in your property and prioritize fixes with the best ROI. This is the single most important first step.

✓ Schedule a free audit through Alabama Power's EarthCents program

✓ Document current energy costs per unit as your baseline

✓ Request a prioritized list of improvements from the auditor

💰 **Identifies $800+/year in potential savings**

2 Quick Wins: Thermostats, LEDs & Sealing

Start with the fastest-payback upgrades. Smart thermostats ($150–$300/unit, 1–2 year payback), LED retrofits ($200–$600, 1–3 year payback), and air sealing ($300–$1,000, 1–3 year payback) require minimal investment and disruption.

✓ Install Nest/Ecobee smart thermostats in every unit

✓ Replace all incandescent/CFL fixtures with LED (75% less energy, 25x lifespan)

✓ Caulk and weatherstrip around windows, doors, pipes, and vents

💰 **Combined: $400–$780/year per unit**

3 Upgrade Insulation

An under-insulated attic turns your property into an oven in Montgomery's heat. Adding R-38+ attic insulation and spray foam in crawl spaces keeps cool air in and hot air out — reducing HVAC load by up to 40%.

✓ Add blown-in cellulose or spray foam to attic spaces

✓ Insulate crawl spaces and basement walls

✓ Check for gaps around ductwork and seal them

💰 **$300–$600/year (payback: 3–6 years)**

4 Upgrade HVAC to Heat Pump System

Replace traditional AC + furnace with a modern heat pump. They handle Montgomery's mild winters and hot summers efficiently. High-SEER units can cut cooling costs by 30–50%.

✓ Get quotes for ENERGY STAR-rated heat pump systems

✓ Apply for federal 30% tax credit under the Inflation Reduction Act

✓ Check Alabama Power's EarthCents program for additional rebates

💰 **$500–$1,000/year (payback: 5–8 years)**

5 Consider Solar & Windows

Longer-term investments with significant returns. Solar panels ($12k–$25k) generate your own electricity with 7–12 year payback. Energy Star windows ($5k–$12k) reduce heat transfer by 30–50% and boost property value.

✓ Get solar quotes — federal 30% tax credit + Alabama incentives reduce net cost

✓ Prioritize south-facing windows for replacement if budget allows

✓ Consider these for properties you plan to hold long-term

💰 **Solar: $1,200–$2,400/year | Windows: $200–$500/year**

6 Install Low-Flow Fixtures & Tankless Water Heaters

Low-flow showerheads and faucet aerators reduce hot water usage by 25–60%. Tankless water heaters eliminate standby energy loss and reduce water heating costs by 20–35%.

✓ Install low-flow showerheads and faucet aerators in all units

✓ Replace aging tank water heaters with tankless units at end of life

✓ Set water heater temperature to 120°F to reduce energy waste

💰 **$350–$500/year combined**

7 Track Results & Communicate with Tenants

Monitor energy costs after each upgrade to validate ROI. Share the savings with tenants — energy-efficient properties attract quality tenants willing to pay higher rent.

✓ Compare utility bills before and after each upgrade

✓ Use the monthly energy checklist to maintain improvements

✓ Market your property's energy efficiency to prospective tenants

💰 **Higher occupancy + rent premiums of 3–7%**

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